

Veiled sentiments

Section Title(S): Marriage, Divorce, And Polygyny

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A number of observations about the role of poetry in matters of the heart can be drawn from this case. Sentiments of attachment to a loved one that violate the moral code, which for women centers on sexual modesty, find expression in poetry. For the most part, these poetic revelations are contradicted by public protestations of indifference and denials of attachment congruent with the cultural ideology about sexual love. When individuals slip and convey messages ■228 in the inappropriate medium, sharp criticism alerts them to their transgression, thus reinforcing the system.

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Human Relations Area Files

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